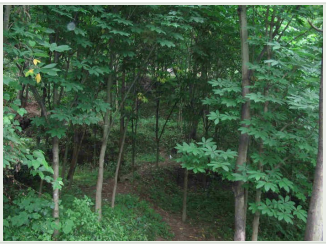
Chinese Buckeye

Aesculus chinensis

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

GARDENS Overlook: 1 **TOTAL 1**



Summer / form
Library candidate

Not available

Fall color
Not available

Not available

Flower
Not available



Leaf close-up
Library candidate

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Deciduous
Mature size: 30–40 ft in cultivation (sources note up to 70 ft in native habitat or ideal conditions). Confirmed by Missouri Botanical Garden, Oregon State, RHS. × 30–40 ft. Confirmed range.
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Marginally suitable for Zone 8a. Sources list Zones 5–7/8. Prefers cooler, consistently moist conditions. May struggle in extreme Atlanta heat and humidity without excellent site selection. Not widely documented in Atlanta plantings. Restart pass (2026-10-13): Limited new-source coverage. Existing notes stand.
Sun: Full sun to part shade.
Water: Medium. Prefers consistent moisture. Avoid dry soils.
Soil: Rich, moist, well-drained loam. Adaptable pH.
Growth rate: Not stated
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: Plant in full sun to part shade in rich, consistently moist, well-drained soil. Avoid dry sites. Water regularly. Suitable as shade or specimen tree. Space for mature spread.
Soil prep: Rich, moist, well-drained loam. Adaptable pH.
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Native to northern China (forests, thickets, slopes). Introduced to Western horticulture. Used as street and temple tree in East Asia.
Form / habit: Deciduous. Rounded crown. Slow to moderate growth.
Foliage: Not consistently stated. Typical buckeye yellow-orange possible.
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Not stated in detail.
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: Potential issues: powdery mildew, verticillium wilt, anthracnose in humid conditions. Seeds are toxic if ingested. **Open:** Specific Zone 8a performance and pest pressure is thin.
Not stated
Additional:
- Showy white flower panicles (May–June), up to 16 in long. - Palmate leaves with 5–7 leaflets. - Spineless fruit capsules with toxic seeds. - Slow growing.